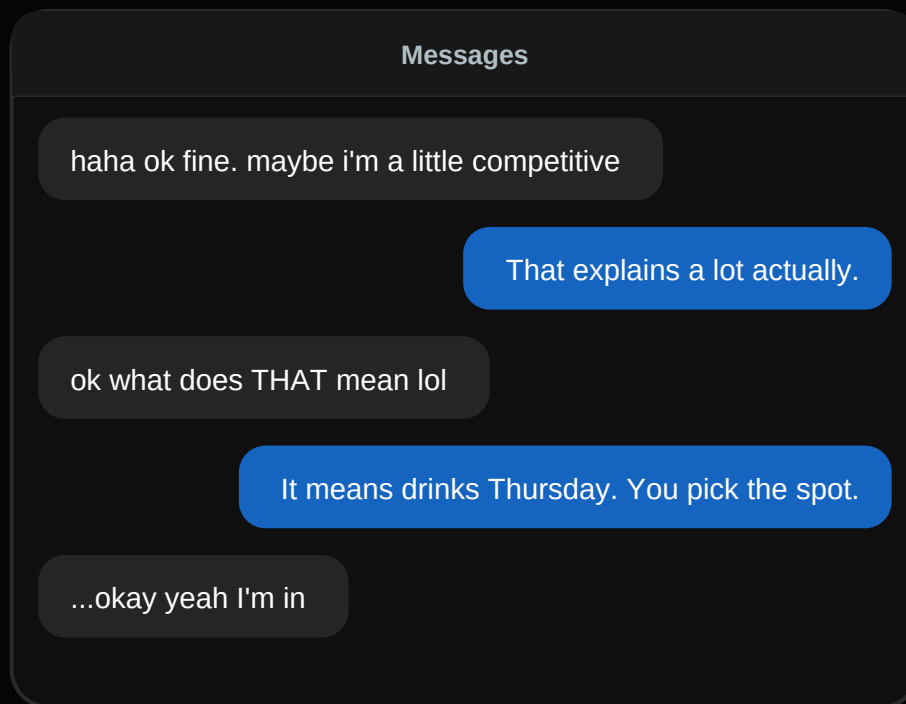


THE SHORT KING SERIES

BOOK ONE

She Replied. Now What?

The Short King's Complete Texting Playbook



Stop Getting Ghosted. Start Getting Dates.

The Short King Coaching

WHO THIS IS FOR

"Getting her number was the easy part. What you do next is where most men lose her. That's where you're about to stop losing."

This book is for the man who gets matches but watches them fade. The man who gets her number but can't get her out. The man who has real conversations that somehow still end in ghosting.

You don't have a confidence problem. You don't have a height problem. You have a **texting system problem**. That's the most fixable problem in dating.

Inside this book you'll find the exact frameworks, scripts, and psychological principles used with real clients to turn dead-end text chains into confirmed dates. No manipulation. No pickup artist theatrics. Just a clear, repeatable system built on how people actually think and feel.

By the end, you'll know how to:

- Open without killing the vibe
- Escalate without being pushy
- Ask her out without sounding desperate
- Recover when she goes cold
- Hold your ground without being a jerk

How to Read This Book: Don't read this passively. Every chapter ends with an action step labeled YOUR MOVE. Do it. Readers who take action get results. Readers who highlight and nod get nothing.

INTRODUCTION

Your Phone Is Killing Your Dates

You know the feeling. You matched with her. She responded to your opener. The conversation had some life to it. And then nothing. Read at 9:47pm. No reply.

Or maybe you got her number in person. She seemed genuinely interested. You texted the next day — something friendly, something reasonable — and she replied with one word. And somewhere in that exchange the energy just... evaporated.

None of this is about your height. None of it is about your looks or your income. It's about the three personality types that kill attraction over text before a date ever gets set.

THE OVER-TEXTER

Responds the second she replies, double-texts when she doesn't, fills silence with questions. She feels his need coming through the screen and it repels her.

THE GHOSTER

Disappears for days trying to seem mysterious, then comes back like nothing happened. She's confused, not intrigued. She moves on.

THE BORING RESPONDER

Matches her energy exactly, keeps things safe and pleasant, and wonders why every conversation fades. She doesn't dislike him. She just doesn't think about him.

Most men rotate between all three depending on the day. The result is always the same: matches that don't convert, numbers that go cold, and a growing suspicion that something is wrong with them specifically.

Nothing is wrong with you. You just haven't had a system.

"I spent years watching shorter men with everything going for them lose women over text to men who were objectively less interesting. Those men understood the game. My clients didn't. Not yet."

This playbook is built on behavioral psychology, real-world coaching results, and frameworks from the most serious thinkers on attraction and human communication — Cialdini on influence, Manson on non-neediness, Strauss on push-pull dynamics.

The goal isn't to turn you into a text wizard. The goal is to give you a clear default — a way of texting that communicates the right things automatically — so that getting dates becomes the natural outcome of your conversations.

CHAPTER ONE

The Texting Mindset

You're Not Chasing. You're Screening.

Before we touch a single script, we need to talk about the thing underneath all of them. Without this, nothing else works consistently.

Most men text women from a place of scarcity. The internal experience goes something like: *she's the prize, I need to impress her, I need this to go well*. Every text is written with one eye on the technique and one eye on whether she'll approve.

That energy doesn't stay hidden. It leaks through everything: the response time, the word choices, the questions asked. She can't always name it, but she feels it. And what she feels is **need**. And need — regardless of height, looks, or anything else — is one of the most repellent forces in human attraction.

"You are not texting to win her approval. You are texting to find out if she's worth your time."

What Abundance Looks Like Text by Text

SCARCITY MINDSET	ABUNDANCE MINDSET
Responds instantly every time	Responds when he's ready
Asks 3 questions, she asks 1	Matches her investment level
Texts first every single day	Lets her initiate sometimes
Over-explains when she's slow	Lets silence breathe
Apologizes for bothering her	Never apologizes for existing
Adjusts personality to please	Is consistently himself

◆ CASE STUDY: MARCUS, 5'7" — THE OVER-TEXTER

Marcus was well-dressed and genuinely funny in person. But when he texted, something changed. He'd respond to every message within minutes. If she took more than an hour, he'd send a follow-up. He asked two or three questions per message and answered all of hers with long, detailed replies. The women he matched with consistently went cold after three or four days. When we looked at his actual text history, the pattern was obvious: he was giving everything and asking for nothing. We ran one experiment. For two weeks, Marcus applied one rule only: match her investment, don't exceed it. He didn't change anything else. Same humor, same personality. Within the first week, two women initiated conversations for the first time. By the end of two weeks, he had three dates scheduled. Same man. Different energy.

■ YOUR
MOVE

Before you send your next text, ask yourself one question: Does this read like a man with options or a man who needs her to respond? If it's the latter, rewrite it. One sentence. Less is almost always more.

Openers That Don't Kill the Vibe

The First Text Is the Gate. Don't Slam It Shut.

Most openers fail for one of two reasons. Either they're too generic — "Hey, how's your week going?" — which gets processed on autopilot. Or they're too try-hard, some elaborate observation that screams *I spent time on this, please like me*.

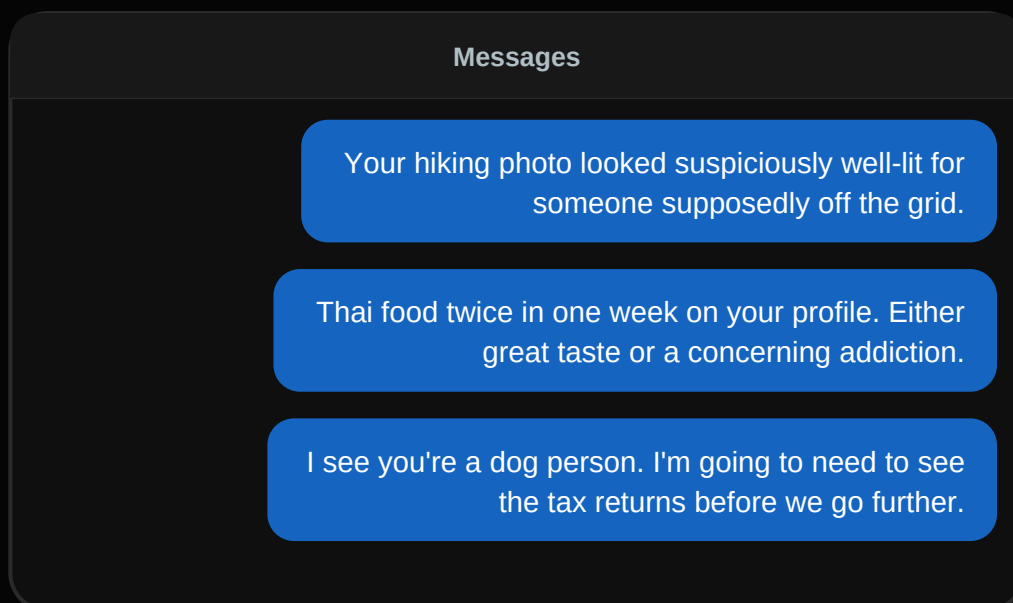
The psychological principle at work here is **pattern interruption**. An opener that breaks the pattern forces conscious attention. It doesn't have to be clever. It has to be different and confident.

The Goldilocks principle: specific enough to show you paid attention, light enough to invite playfulness rather than pressure.

The Three Opener Frameworks

1. THE CALLBACK OPENER

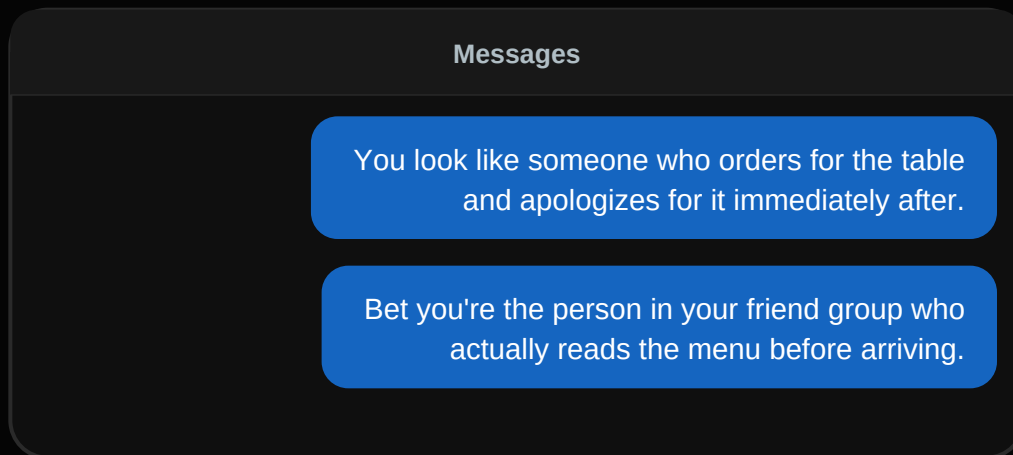
References something specific from her profile as a comment, not a question. Questions put conversational pressure on her immediately. Comments invite her in without demanding a response.



2. THE ASSUMPTION OPENER

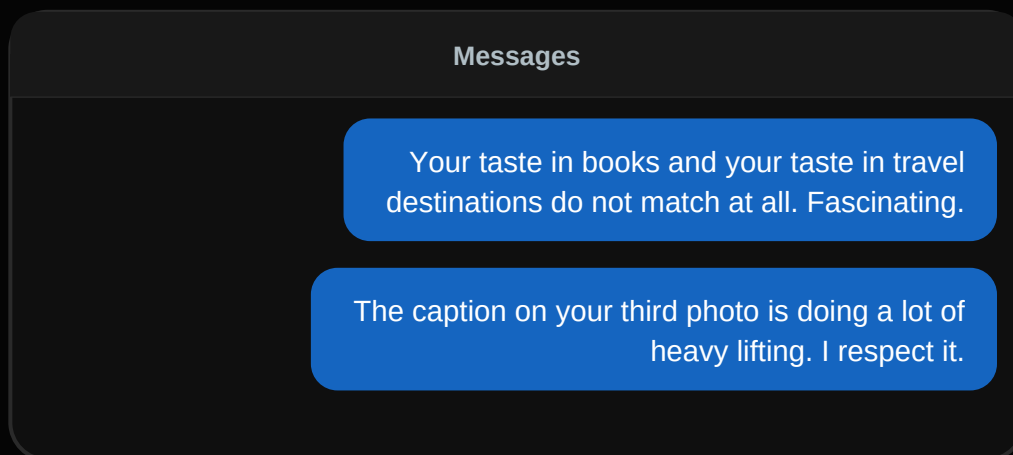
Lead with a playful assumption about her. This signals you formed an opinion about her rather than just swiping right on autopilot. Gives her something to confirm or push back on — both open a

conversation.



3. THE OBSERVATION OPENER

A short, confident observation that doesn't require her to explain herself. Works best when slightly unexpected — not what she'd predict as a first message.



◆ CASE STUDY: REAL CASE: THE SAME MATCH, TWO DIFFERENT OPENERS

A client had already messaged a match once. His opener: "Hey! How's your week going?" — no response in four days. She was still active on the app. We looked at her profile. She had a photo at a very specific farmers market — overpriced candles, live acoustic guitar. New message: "That farmers market has a very specific clientele. Are you there for the produce or the vibe?" She responded within twenty minutes: "Okay BOTH and I won't apologize for it." They went on a date six days later. Same woman. Same profile. Different opener.

■ YOUR MOVE

Before your next opener, look at her profile for sixty seconds. Find one specific detail. Write a comment about it — not a question. Make it observational and slightly playful. Send it without spending more than five minutes on it. Overthinking kills more openers than bad ideas.

The Escalation Ladder

Moving From Polite to Magnetic

Here's the problem with most text conversations: they flatline. The opener lands. She responds. And then the entire exchange stays at the same emotional temperature for days — friendly, pleasant, and completely forgettable.

Most men confuse rapport with attraction. **Rapport is 'we get along fine.'** **Attraction is 'I'm thinking about this person when I should be thinking about something else.'** Rapport is built through pleasant consistency. Attraction is built through emotional variety.

The Four Rungs

RUN G 1	Light & Playful Banter, observations, light teasing. No weight, no pressure. Where most conversations start — and where bad ones stay permanently.
RUN G 2	Teasing & Challenging Introduce a little friction. Disagree playfully. Push back on something she said, gently and with humor. Where attraction separates from friendliness.
RUN G 3	Personal & Real Ask about something that actually matters. Share something genuine about yourself — just a window. Where connection forms underneath the attraction.
RUN G 4	Tension & Anticipation Subtle flirtation. Things left slightly unsaid. The hint of something more without spelling it out. Where she starts thinking about you when she puts her phone down.

Escalation in Action

Messages

How was your weekend?

Good. Did something that was either very adventurous or a terrible idea. Still deciding.

Now I'm curious.

You seem like someone who plays it safe on weekends. Am I wrong?

Excuse me, I'm spontaneous.

Most people who lead with 'I'm spontaneous' have a very structured morning routine.

Okay fine. But I DO have strong opinions about Sundays.

Same. What's yours?

◆ CASE STUDY: DEREK, 5'6" — THE FRIENDLY FLATLINER

Derek was easy to talk to. He had good conversations with women. They'd text back and forth for days, sometimes weeks. But the conversations never went anywhere. He was firmly in the friend zone before they'd even met. Every single conversation lived on Rung 1. Light, funny, pleasant, safe. He never challenged anything she said. He never shared anything real. He never introduced any tension. We introduced one change: every third response, he had to move up a rung. Just one notch. A gentle push-back, a genuine question about something that mattered, a line that left something unsaid. Within a week she asked him something personal first — something that had never happened before. Three days later she suggested they get coffee.

■ YOUR
MOVE

Look at your most recent active conversation. Identify which rung it's currently living on. In your next message, move one rung higher. Just one. Don't announce it. Just do it.

Date-Setting Scripts That Close

Stop Hoping She'll Bring It Up

The biggest texting failure point isn't openers or escalation. It's men who build real rapport with a woman over text and then **never actually ask her out**.

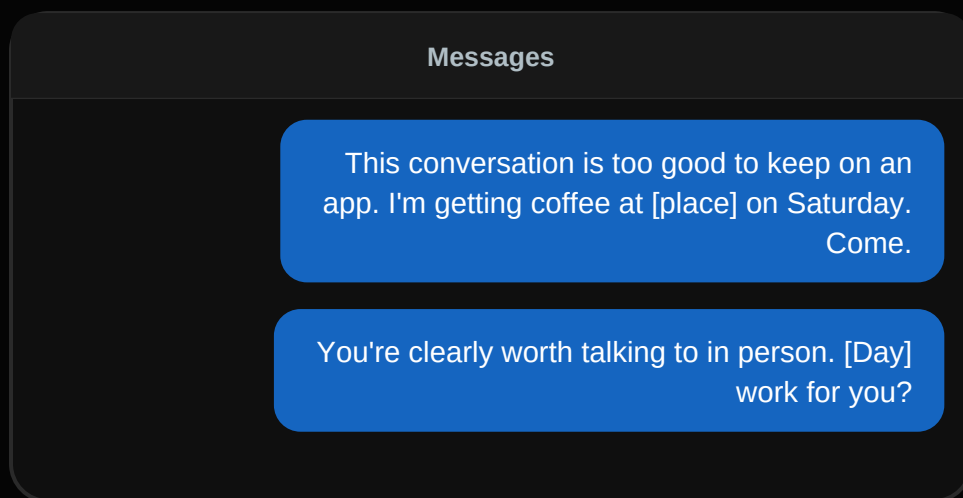
They keep the conversation going because the conversation feels good. They're afraid that asking will break the spell. She can feel this. It reads as either lack of interest or lack of confidence — neither of which she finds attractive.

The **assumptive close** works differently: it leads with a plan, which frames the date as already happening. She's opting out rather than opting in — a psychologically easier decision.

Three Date-Setting Scenarios

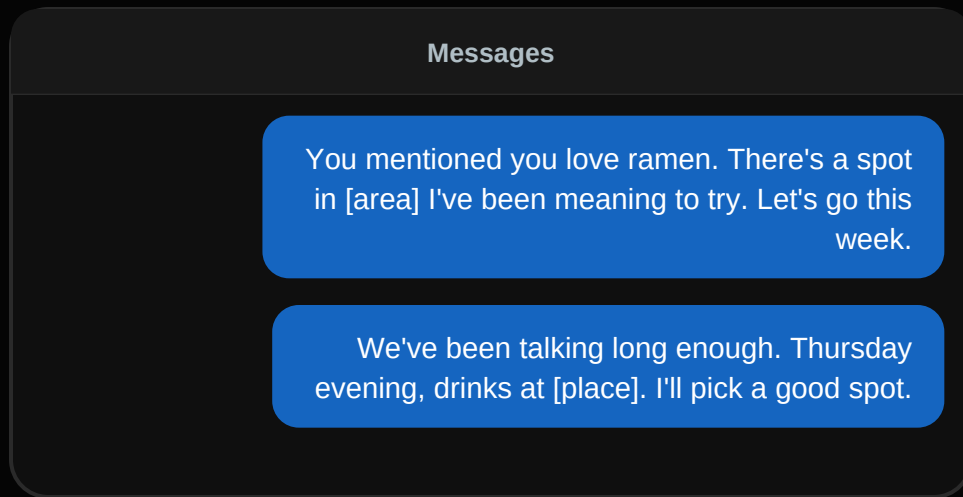
SCENARIO A: Early In Conversation (3–5 messages in)

Best for high-energy matches where conversation clicked quickly. Don't overthink the build-up. Set the date before the energy fades.



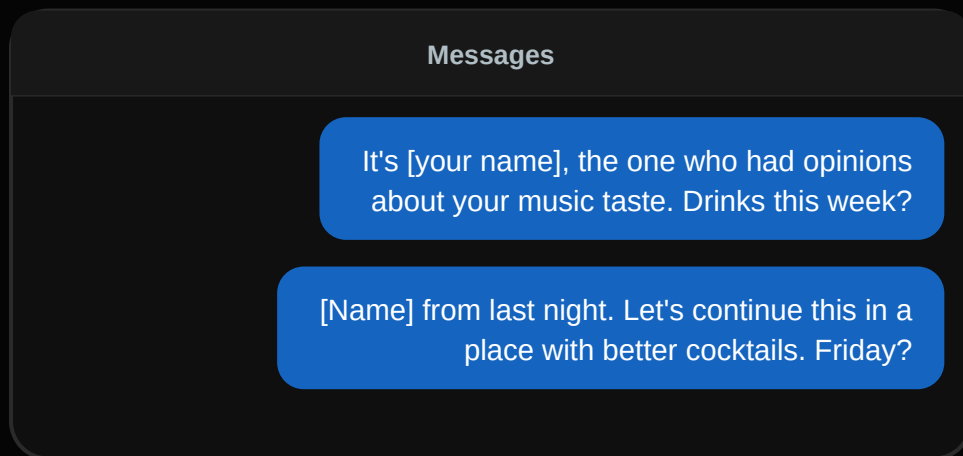
SCENARIO B: After Strong Rapport (several days in)

You've had real back-and-forth. Make the invitation specific — specific invitations convert better because they require less imagination on her part.



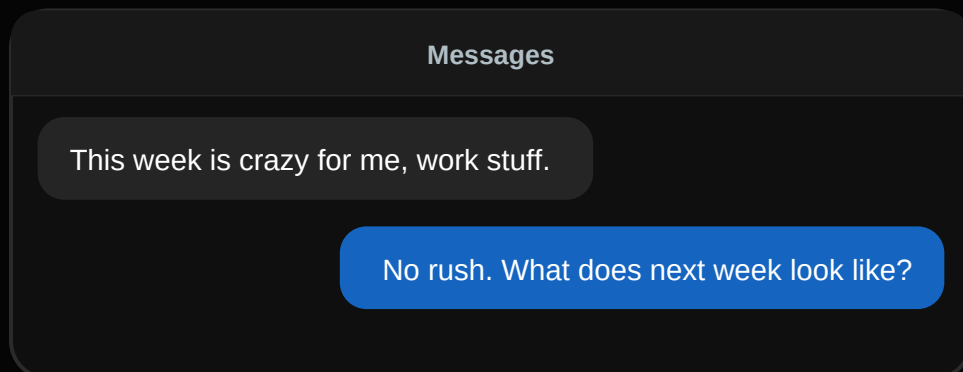
SCENARIO C: After Getting Her Number in Person

She already met you. The attraction is already there. Don't restart the whole conversation on text. Get to the point.



Handling "I'm Busy"

"I'm busy" is one of the most misread texts in dating. A genuine scheduling conflict sounds different from a soft no — there's usually something specific attached, some acknowledgment she wants to make it work.



Messages

Haha maybe sometime, things are just really hectic lately.

No worries. I'll let you know when I'm putting something together.

◆ CASE STUDY: REAL CASE: THE 11-DAY MATCH

A client had been texting a match for eleven days. Good conversation — genuine laughs, real exchanges. He hadn't asked her out because, as he put it, "it was going so well I didn't want to ruin it." We sent the assumptive close: "You've been keeping this conversation going for almost two weeks. Clearly means you can handle having a drink with me. Tomorrow night?" She said yes within four minutes. He told me afterward that he'd been afraid of the question for eleven days and the answer took four minutes. The fear of asking is almost always more painful than the asking itself.

■ YOUR MOVE

If you have any match you've been talking to for more than five days without a date set, send the close today. Use one of the scripts above as your template. Adapt it to your voice. Send it before you finish this book.

She Went Cold

The Save System for Every Scenario

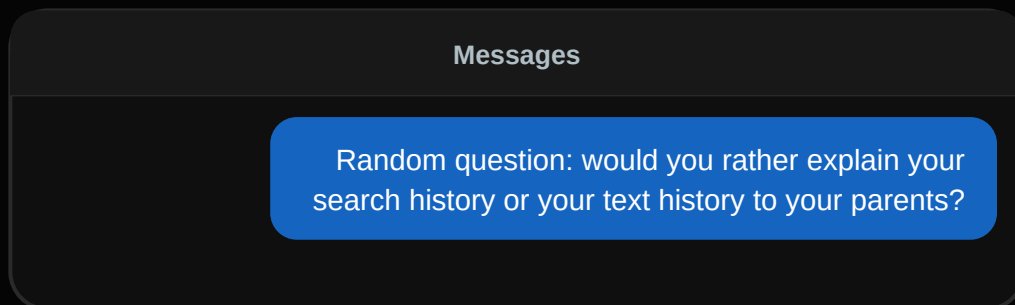
This happens to every man who dates via text, regardless of height, looks, or how well the conversation was going. Women go cold for many reasons, most of which have nothing to do with you.

The mistake: interpreting silence as rejection and responding with either an anxious follow-up — confirming her suspicions about your neediness — or wounded silence that lets something potentially recoverable die.

Three Scenarios, Three Saves

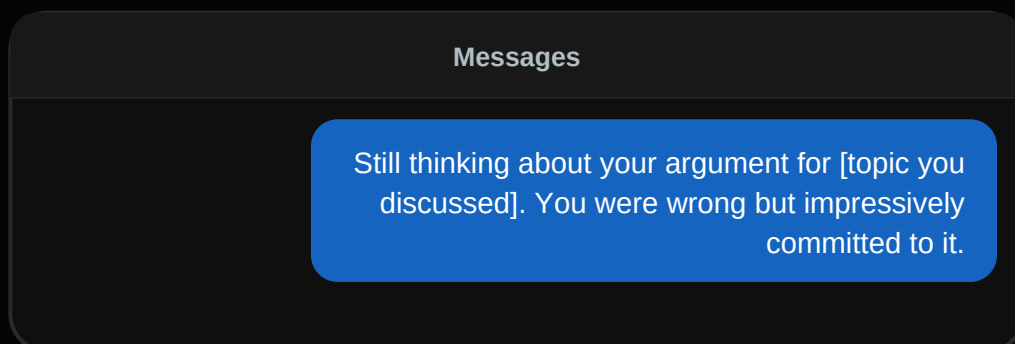
Scenario 1: She Went Quiet Mid-Conversation

Wait at least 48–72 hours before sending anything. Then hit her with something completely unrelated to where you left off — a new thread, not a continuation of the old one.



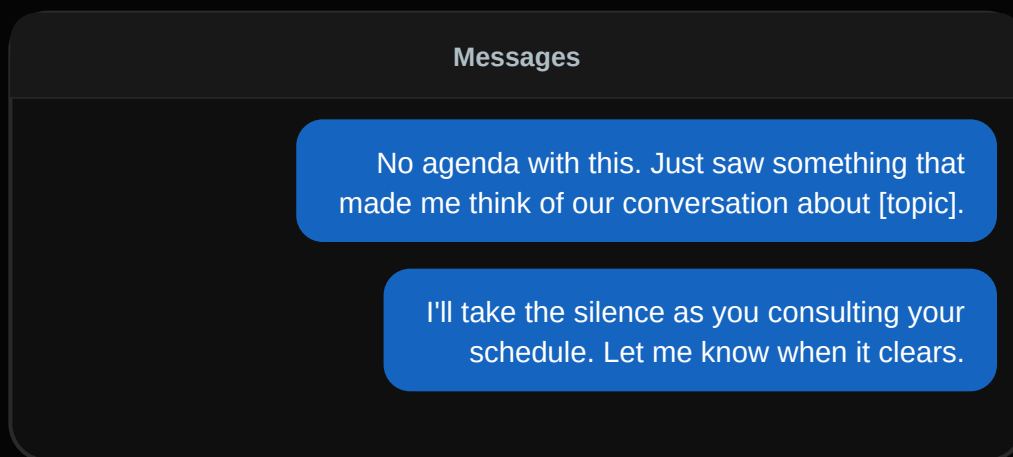
Scenario 2: She Went Quiet After a Great Date

Wait two full days after the date. Then send a callback — something that references a specific moment from the date itself. This reactivates the attraction associated with it.



Scenario 3: She Went Quiet After You Asked Her Out

Give it 4–5 days, then send one more message — not a follow-up on the invitation, but something that shows you've moved on from it entirely.



◆ CASE STUDY: JORDAN, 5'8" — THE OVER-CHASER

Jordan had a match go quiet after what he described as "probably the best text conversation I've ever had." She'd been engaged for twelve days, then silence. His response: three messages over 48 hours — a check-in, a meme, then "hey, did I say something wrong?" We waited four days, then sent a single pattern interrupt message with a new thread. No reference to the previous conversation, no apology. She responded within three hours: "Sorry I've been MIA, things have been insane." They had the date within a week. Three messages told her everything about his anxiety. One well-timed message told her everything about his composure.

■ YOUR MOVE

Identify one cold conversation in your phone right now. Diagnose which of the three scenarios applies. Write the save message — but don't send it for at least 24 more hours if she went cold less than 72 hours ago. Patience is part of the technique.

Holding the Line

Boundaries That Build Attraction

Somewhere in the dating advice world, 'boundaries' became a therapy word — soft, apologetic, something you whisper rather than embody. Let me tell you what a boundary actually is in the context of dating:

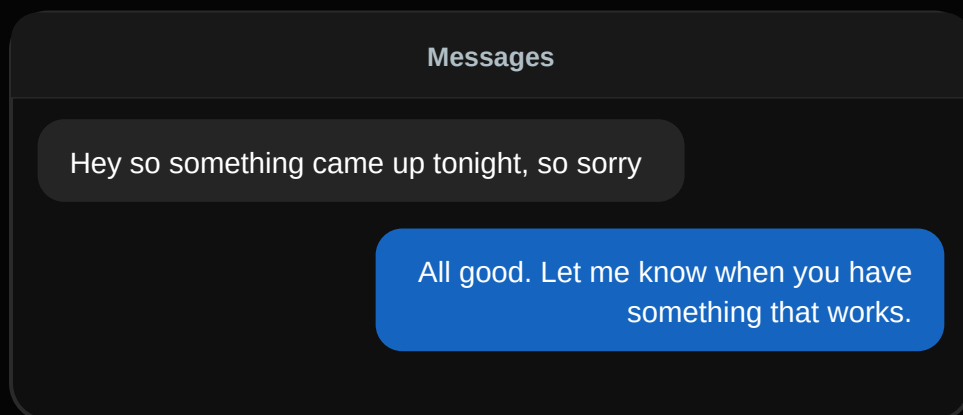
"A boundary is what happens when a man's self-respect becomes visible behavior."

The reason boundaries work isn't manipulation. It's that they're honest. When you hold a line calmly — no drama, no punishment, just a clear redirect — you're showing her exactly who you are. A man who doesn't bend himself out of shape for approval. That's genuinely rare. And it's genuinely attractive.

The Three Most Common Boundary Moments

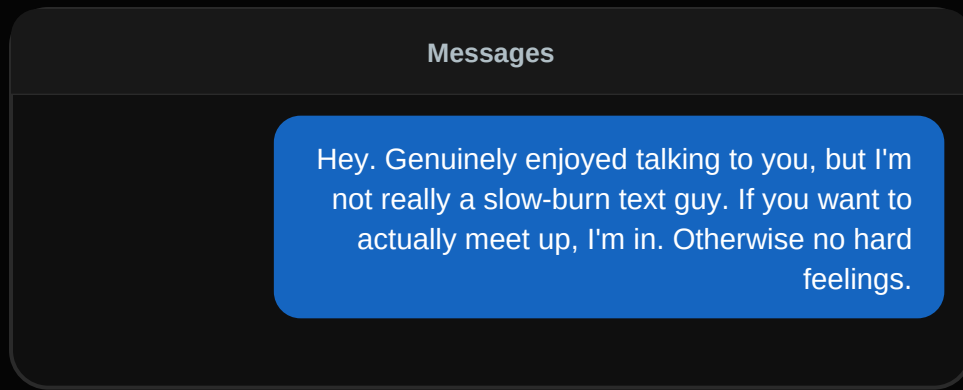
1. She Flakes on a Confirmed Plan

She cancelled day-of with a vague reason and no offer to reschedule. The wrong response: "no worries, we'll figure it out!" — which tells her there are no consequences to disrespecting your time.



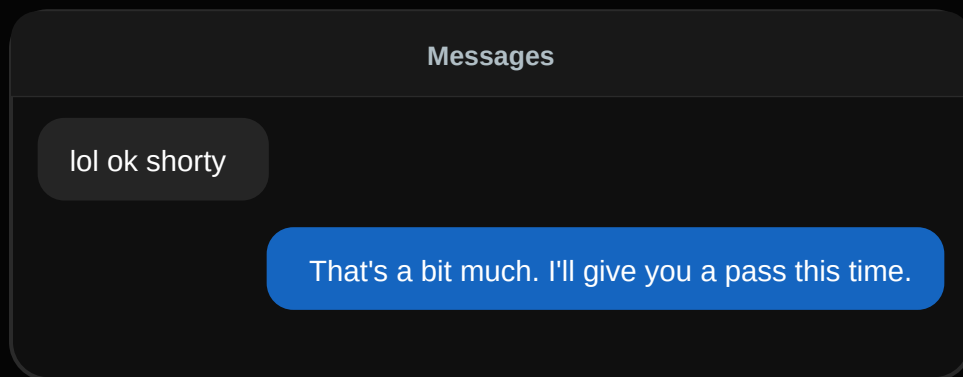
2. She'sBreadcrumbing

She keeps the conversation intermittently alive — enough to maintain your interest but not enough to go anywhere. She's keeping you warm without committing to the heat.



3. She's Disrespectful or Dismissive

Most men either fire back angrily or absorb it silently. Both are wrong.



◆ CASE STUDY: REAL CASE: THE FLAKE THAT BECAME A FIRST DATE

A client had a woman cancel two hours before a confirmed dinner, citing "work stuff" with no offer to reschedule. His previous instinct: "totally understand, hope things calm down!" and ask when she was free. Instead he sent: "All good. Let me know when you have something that works." That was it. He didn't follow up. Four days later she texted him unprompted with three alternative dates she was available. He picked one. She showed up early. On their third date she told him she "couldn't figure him out at first" in a way she found compelling. That ambiguity was just his self-respect being visible.

■ YOUR MOVE

Write out your personal line — one sentence that describes the texting behavior you will no longer accept without consequence. Flaking? Disrespect?Breadcrumbing? Name it specifically. Knowing your line before the moment arrives means you won't have to think in the heat of it.

Texting Quick Reference

Screenshot this. Check it before you send anything important.

THE 7 NON-NEGOTIABLES

- 01 Match her investment. Never exceed it consistently.
- 02 Lead with comments, not questions.
- 03 Move through the four rungs. Don't flatline on pleasant.
- 04 Use the assumptive close. Plan, not a question.
- 05 When she goes cold, wait. One pattern interrupt only.
- 06 Hold your line calmly. No drama. No chase.
- 07 Does this read like a man with options?

OPENER FRAMEWORKS

- Callback** Specific detail from her profile. Comment, not question.
- Assumption** Playful assumption. Gives her something to confirm or push back on.
- Observation** Short, confident, slightly unexpected.

THE ESCALATION LADDER

- Rung 1** Light and playful
- Rung 2** Teasing and challenging
- Rung 3** Personal and real
- Rung 4** Tension and anticipation

DATE-SETTING

- Early** Invite before the energy fades. 3-5 messages in.
- Built rapport** Specific plan, specific day, specific place.
- In-person number** Get to it fast. She already met you.

SAVE SYSTEM

- Mid-convo cold** Wait 72hrs. New thread, unrelated topic.
- Post-date cold** Wait 48hrs. Callback to a date moment.
- Post-invite cold** Wait 4-5 days. Low-pressure new message.

You've got the texts handled. She said yes to the date. Now what?

You've built the system. You know how to open without killing the vibe, move the conversation forward without flatlining, close for the date without flinching, recover when things go cold, and hold your ground when she tests yours. That's the full text game.

But here's what happens to a lot of men once they get the date: they show up and leave everything to chance. They run out of things to say. They freeze at the end of the night and leave without going for the kiss.

The First Date Blueprint: From Hello to Goodnight Kiss

Book Two in the Short King Series

- Pre-date preparation and the 24 hours before
 - Conversation flow and the three phases every great date moves through
 - Flirting checkpoints and how to calibrate physical touch
 - How to go for the kiss with confidence
 - How to end the date so she's already thinking about the next one
-

"You don't need to be taller. You need to be better. And better is something you can actually build."

THE SHORT KING COMPLETE SYSTEM

All seven books. Every system from texting to dating profile to first date to confidence to conversation to approach. The full transformation in one place. Every book works as a standalone. Together they're a complete operating system for dating as a shorter man.

Want personalized coaching?

The books give you the system. Coaching gives you someone to run it with — reviewing your actual conversations, identifying your specific patterns, and accelerating your results with direct feedback.

Reach out through the Short King Coaching platform.



Welcome to the kingdom.